

Buying Group *Mapping Framework*

Seven stakeholder roles × Five buying stages
Engagement priorities at every intersection

Most ABM programs do not fail because they target the wrong accounts.
They fail because they only engage part of the buying committee.

This framework maps every stakeholder who shapes a B2B purchase decision
against the five stages of the buying journey — so you know exactly who
to engage, with what, and when.

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STAKEHOLDER ROLES

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BUYING STAGES

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ENGAGEMENT CELLS

1

WORKING FRAMEWORK

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*The deals that close without drama are almost
always the ones where marketing helped the
entire room say yes — not just the one person
willing to take the sales call.*

— ERIK R. MILLER · E.R.M. ADVISORY

Engagement priority at every intersection of stakeholder role and buying stage.

STAKEHOLDER	Awareness <i>Why now?</i>	Validation <i>Does it fit?</i>	Consensus <i>Can we align?</i>	Approval <i>Is it worth it?</i>	Purchase <i>Close it out.</i>
Economic Buyer Controls budget. Makes final call.	High	Medium	High	High	
Executive Sponsor Senior advocate. Internal seller.	High	Medium	High	Medium	
Business Champion Owns the problem. Drives evaluation.	Medium	High	High	Medium	
Technical Evaluator Validates integration and scale.		High	Medium	Medium	
Procurement Process, contracts, vendor requirements.		Low	Medium	High	High
Risk & Compliance Org requirement, not an objection.		Low	Medium	High	High
End User Lives with the solution daily.		Medium	High	Low	

ENGAGEMENT PRIORITY

Not yet in play

Low

Medium

HOW TO READ THIS

High = build content and run outreach for this cell now.

Low = monitor. Not yet in play = hold until the stage is reached.

What each stakeholder cares about, what content they need, and where they are most likely to create friction.

Economic Buyer

Controls the budget and makes or formally approves the final decision. Cares about business outcomes, ROI clarity, and strategic fit. Does not want to be sold to. Wants to make a well-informed decision that reflects well on them internally.

Executive Sponsor

A senior internal advocate who has decided this purchase aligns with an organizational priority. Often the primary sales team relationship. Influential but rarely the decision-maker alone. Running an internal sales process on your behalf.

CONTENT TO BUILD

- Champion enablement kit: talking points, objection responses
- Internal summary (designed to be forwarded)
- Competitive positioning for internal alignment
- Consensus-stage one-pagers for their leadership

Business Champion

The internal operator who will live with the solution and drives the day-to-day evaluation. Cares about fit, usability, and whether this genuinely solves the problem they own. Your most honest critic or most powerful advocate.

Technical Evaluator

Validates whether the solution integrates with existing infrastructure, scales as claimed, and meets security standards. Often operates independently from business stakeholders and rarely appears in CRM until they have already formed a view.

CONTENT TO BUILD

- Integration documentation and API references
- Security posture: SOC 2, certifications, data governance
- Performance benchmarks and architecture diagrams
- Technical FAQ anticipating their hardest questions

Procurement

Manages vendor process, contracts, and compliance requirements. Not a decision-maker in the traditional sense, but holds full veto power through process control. Engaging early is not bureaucratic overhead · it is deal hygiene.

Risk & Compliance

Increasingly influential in regulated industries and larger organizations. Their concerns are not objections to handle. They are organizational requirements to address. Common in financial services, healthcare, government, and enterprise tech.

CONTENT TO BUILD

- Security and compliance one-pager (proactive)
- Data residency and governance documentation
- Regulatory fit summary for their industry
- Reference contacts at comparable regulated organizations

End User

The people who will actually use the product or service daily. Frequently excluded from ABM because they are not on the decision-making org chart. That framing misses something important: their grassroots enthusiasm gives champions internal proof.

What your program should be building and deploying at each stage of the buying journey.

01 AWARENESS *Why does this problem matter now?*

The buyer is not yet actively evaluating. Your job is to create category-level relevance — not pitch the product.

- Economic Buyer:** Business problem framing, cost-of-inaction content, ind
- Executive Sponsor:** Strategic priority alignment, analyst perspectives, exe
- Business Champion:** Problem validation content, peer stories, challenge ide
- Technical Evaluator:** Category-level technical content, light awareness only
- Procurement:** Not yet in play
- Risk & Compliance:** Not yet in play
- End User:** Not yet in play

02 VALIDATION *Does this actually work for us?*

Active evaluation underway. Technical and business stakeholders are doing real work. This is your heaviest content investment stage.

- Economic Buyer:** Light touch — let champions lead. High-level fit summar
- Executive Sponsor:** Strategic capability proof, differentiation versus alte
- Business Champion:** In-depth demos, use case walkthroughs, ROI calculators,
- Technical Evaluator:** Integration docs, security posture, architecture, techn
- Procurement:** Vendor process intro, timeline overview, contract frame
- Risk & Compliance:** Early compliance documentation, data governance overvie
- End User:** Usability proof, day-in-the-life walkthroughs, adoption

03 CONSENSUS *Can we align internally?*

The most common deal-stall stage. Your champion is running an internal sales process. Give them everything they need to do it.

- Economic Buyer:** Org readiness signals, strategic alignment summary
- Executive Sponsor:** Champion kit: talking points, objection responses, exec
- Business Champion:** Internal business case support, competitive comparison,
- Technical Evaluator:** Technical summary written for non-technical leadership
- Procurement:** Vendor requirements documentation, contract framework
- Risk & Compliance:** Risk summary, compliance checklist, regulatory fit brie
- End User:** Reassurance content, adoption roadmap, peer testimonial

04 APPROVAL *Is it worth it?*

Economic buyer makes the call. Risk and procurement are fully engaged. Your content must justify the decision clearly and remove doubt.

- Economic Buyer:** Business case document, financial modeling, strategic o
- Executive Sponsor:** Internal alignment support, implementation confidence m
- Business Champion:** Implementation plan preview, success metrics framework
- Technical Evaluator:** Final technical sign-off documentation, SLA terms
- Procurement:** Full negotiation documentation, final contract review
- Risk & Compliance:** Formal review package, certifications, legal review sup
- End User:** Light endorsement support, onboarding preview

05 PURCHASE *Close it out.*

Mostly procurement and compliance. Deals that stall here almost always have an unresolved requirement from Risk, Compliance, or Procurement.

- Economic Buyer:** Final decision support — minimal if prior stages done w
- Executive Sponsor:** Transition and onboarding readiness
- Business Champion:** Implementation kickoff materials
- Technical Evaluator:** Implementation specifications and technical handoff
- Procurement:** Contract execution, vendor onboarding, payment terms
- Risk & Compliance:** Final compliance close, security confirmation
- End User:** Onboarding preparation and success planning

Use this worksheet for each tier-one account. Complete with sales before the first campaign brief is written.

ACCOUNT NAME	INDUSTRY	DEAL STAGE	PRIMARY CONTACT

BUYING GROUP ROSTER

List the actual people. Names, titles, and what you know about each one.

ROLE	NAME / TITLE	DEPT	COVERAGE STATUS	KEY CONCERN
Economic Buyer				
Executive Sponsor				
Business Champion				
Technical Evaluator				
Procurement				
Risk & Compliance				
End User				
Additional Stakeholder				

COVERAGE GAP ANALYSIS

For each high-priority cell with no coverage, note the content asset or outreach needed.

STAKEHOLDER	BUYING STAGE	PRIORITY	CONTENT / ACTION NEEDED

DIAGNOSTIC QUESTION

If your primary contact left this organization tomorrow, would the deal survive?

If no: the buying group roster above is incomplete. Find and map the committee before your next campaign brief.